Knowledge Organiser

Describe the Sun, Earth and Moon as approximately spherical bodies.

The Sun is a star. Earth is a planet. The Moon is Earth’s natural satellite.

Clue	What the clue tells us
Ship at the horizon	A curved surface hides the low hull first. Distance alone would make the whole ship look smaller.
Shadow during a lunar eclipse	A sphere makes a round shadow from different directions. A flat disc can make a round shadow from one direction.
Photographs from space	Repeated images from different viewpoints show the whole Earth’s rounded outline directly.
Travel all the way round	The journey fits a globe, but a closed route by itself does not show the shape of the surface.

Size and scale

The Sun is about 109 Earths across. The Moon is about a quarter of Earth’s width. The torch and ball model shows a shadow but does not show real sizes or distances.